Maple Grove Track and Field 2026 Handbook

Maple Grove Coaching Staff

Sean Heaton	Head Coach/Distance	HeatonS@district279.org
Mike Herdan	Sprints	
Allison Gerads	Sprints	
Gid Heroux	Sprints	
Jack Flynn	Sprints	
Abby Stoesz	Sprints	
Paul Meloche	Hurdles	
Mike Kuhlman	Distance	
Hannah Hempe	Distance	HempeH@district279.org
Mackenzie Waataja	Distance	
Lauren Tillman	Distance	
Matt Detloff	Throws	DetloffM@district279.org
Val Vinokur	Throws	
Andrew Norman	Pole Vault	
Shawn Schindler	Pole Vault	
Kaylee Fisher	LJ, TJ	
Randy Khieu	LJ, TJ	
Suntina Spehar	High Jump	
Javan Copley	Strength	

Captains

Grade	Name	Group	Grade	Name	Group
12	Drake Wegscheid	Sprints	12	Keynan Allee	Hurdles
12	April Watson	Distance	12	Luke Bottema	Sprints
12	Gavin Nelson	Pole Vault	11	Lucas Capistrant	Distance
12	Sasha Kowalski	Pole Vault	11	Sam Jacobson	Sprints
12	Persi Gaffney	Throws	11	Cole Kalkwarf	Jumps
12	Aubrey Steel	Hurdles			

Registration

All athletes must register with the athletic office before they are allowed to practice. This includes paying the activity fee and getting a physical if you have not had one in the last three years. Registration information can be found on the track website or the Maple Grove Senior High athletics page. Registration is online through SMART SCHOOL.

Communication

- The Safeteam/Helloteam App is used for weekly communications, just-in-time updates, and meet results. Download HelloTeam App on your phone.
- Fill out this form to get enrolled on our app https://zfrmz.com/EOrq3g1LfQWTzdKj7Nwt

Practice

- Practice for senior high students begins on Monday, March 9th at 3:00 pm, finishing between 4:30 and 5:00. Practice for middle school students starts on Thursday, March 12th at 3:15pm, finishing at 4:45pm.
- Locker rooms are available for changing into your track clothes. Do NOT leave your personal items in the locker room. Secure all valuable items, do not leave them sitting out unattended.
- **When you cross the street to go to the track use the crosswalk at the light.** There are accidents that happen in front of the school, do not be the cause of one.

Transportation

- Middle School Students; activity buses leave the middle schools at 2:50 each day and will drop you off at the HS. **The bus leaves MGMS (route 270) leaves the front side of the building, OMS (route 374) leaves on the east side of the building.** When you arrive at the high school, change quickly and go to your coach, you have a limited time to practice. Be polite and don't run around in the school.
- A Late bus is available Tuesday-Thursday. Buses leave the high school door A at 4:45 PM. The main office receives a report of students that are assigned to late activity busses each week
- On "away" meet days, we will come pick you up at the middle school if you are competing in the meet. If it is a home meet you will take the activities bus to the high school as though it was practice. After meets, buses will always return athletes to the high school only.
- For more specific information, contact busquestions@district279.org

Attendance

- **BE ON TIME!** All athletes are expected to attend practice each day and daily attendance will be documented at the beginning of practice. Captains and coaches will lead your group in a warm-up and stretching and announcements will be made.
- Attendance at practice helps determine event participation at meets and will help determine your ability to earn a varsity letter.
- Varsity and JV athletes will have some scheduled practices on Saturdays that are pre-arranged and communicated by their area coach. All absences (unexcused or excused) must be communicated directly to the athlete's area coach in advance of the

absence.

- Multiple absences will be handled by the following actions:
    - After the first absence, coaches will talk with the athlete.
    - After the second absence, the coaches have the right to withhold participation from a meet*/ev*ent.
    - The third unexcused absence will result in the removal from the team.
- Excused absences may include illness, doctor's appointments, a major family event, or required school event that cannot be scheduled at an alternate time.

Meet Participation

- To qualify for participation in a meet an athlete must be in good academic standing and participate in practices throughout the entire season. Athletes that are held out of practice for injury or academic or behavior misconduct may also be held from competing in a meet. Additionally, If an athlete has an **unexcused** absence the week or day before a competition which impacts the performance of the athlete and/or relay, the coach may withdraw the athlete from an even*t/s.* Athletes must communicate their planned absences in advance with the coach in order to be considered for participation in a meet.
- At track meets, athletes are expected to prepare for competition; when they are not, they should be encouraging other athletes in the meet. The expectation is that athletes will stay to the end of the meet to encourage their teammates.
- If an athlete plans to ride home from a meet with a parent and not on a bus a written note needs to be given to a coach 24 hours before the meet (this allows us to accommodate bus schedules).

Spectators

- **Only athletes and coaches should be in the competition area.** This includes the track, infield, throwing vectors, jumping, and pole vaulting areas. Please remain in the areas designated for spectators at each meet. Interfering with an athlete's competition could result in your athlete being disqualified.

Uniforms

- *Y*ou will be issued a team uniform before the first meet**.** DO NOT share your uniform. You are responsible for the uniform. If you lose it you will have to pay for a new one. Make sure you remove hip numbers before you wash your uniform or the adhesive will damage it.

Injuries

- If you think you have an injury, tell your coach and see the trainer. The trainer’s office is located in the athletic hallway. There is no charge to get an evaluation. Results of evaluation should be shared with your coach and parent/guardian.

Chemical Policy

- By joining the track and field team athletes are agreeing to follow the chemical free rules defined by Maple Grove Senior High School and the Minnesota State High School League. Violations will be handled according to MSHSL and District policy.

Respect and Cooperation

- Cooperate and be courteous with your coaches and captains. We will always work in your best interest and in the best interest of the team. Each track athlete is expected to exhibit exemplary behavior while representing Maple Grove Senior High. Respect officials, your teammates, coaches and especially your competition.

Tryouts

- Monday March 9th - Friday March 13th will be high school tryouts. Tryouts are open to only athletes who are registered for track and field.
- 8th grade tryouts begin on March 12th at 3:15pm. There will be two sessions of 8th grade tryouts on Thursday March 13th and a final session on Friday March 13th at 3:15pm.
- You can only register with the high school you are scheduled to attend based on school boundaries. Please make sure you do not register for another high school's team.
- No 7th grade athletes may register or tryout for Maple Grove Track and Field team due to team size constraints. Our coaching staff and facilities cannot safely handle the number of student athletes that annually wish to participate on our team.
- Tryout results will be communicated on Helloteam over the weekend of the 14th of March. Athletes who do not make the team will have their registration fee and booster fee refunded in full.
- Team selection will be based on athletic performance per event area and overall conduct during the first week of practice.

For Frequently Asked Questions and Responses, check out this link:

2026 MGTF - Frequently Asked Questions

2026 Track and Field Schedule

Date	Location	Meet Name	Who Competes
4/2	Maple Grove	Lake Conference Regular Season	All
4/9	Maple Grove	Lake Conference Regular Season	JV
4/10	Hopkins	Lake Conference Relays	Varsity
4/14	Eden Prairie	Lake Conference Regular Season	All
4/21	Minnetonka	Joe Lane/Rogness Invitational	Varsity
4/23	STMA	Lake Conference JV Meet	JV
4/24	Hamline University	Hamline Elite Meet	Qualifying athletes
4/28	Maple Grove	Crimson Invite	Varsity
4/30	Maple Grove	Lake Conference JV Meet	JV
5/5	Rogers	Varsity True Team Sections	Varsity
5/7	Maple Grove	Lake Conference JV Meet	JV
5/12	Maple Grove	District 279 Meet	Top 8 in each event
5/15	Eden Prairie	True Team State (Class AAA)	Qualifying Teams
5/19	Buffalo	Lake Conference Championships	Varsity
5/27	Forest Lake	Section 5AAA Prelims	Varsity
5/29	Forest Lake	Section 5AAA Finals	Varsity
6/4	STMA	State Meet Prelims (Class AAA)	Qualifying athletes
6/6	STMA	State Meet Finals (Class AAA)	Qualifying athletes

2026 Maple Grove Track and Field Lettering Policy

To be considered for lettering, all track and field student athletes must meet BOTH of the following requirements:

A. Maintain MSHSL Eligibility throughout the duration of the season.

B. Be in good standing with coaches and team

- This includes but is not limited to, ZERO unexcused absences

In addition to the above expectations, athletes must also attain one of the 3 following benchmarks:

1. Participating in 5 Varsity meets of a single season (or approximately 70% of the Varsity Regular Season)
2. Represent our team at TWO of the following meets:
   a. True Team Sections
   b. Lake Conference Championships
   c. Section 5AA Championships
   d. State Championships
3. Achieve a lettering standard TWICE at a varsity meet using Fully Automated Timing (F.A.T.).

Lettering Standards

Boys Lettering Mark	
100M	11.9
200M	23.8
400M	53.0
800M	2:05
1600M	4:57
3200M	10:38
110H	17.0
300H	42.8
Long Jump	19'7"
Triple Jump	39'11"
High Jump	5'8"
Pole Vault	10'6"
Shot Put	41'0"
Discus	115'0"

Girls Lettering Mark	
100M	13.3
200M	27.6
400M	62.0
800M	2:25
1600M	5:33
3200M	12.35
110H	17.37
300H	50
Long Jump	15'6"
Triple Jump	33'1"
High Jump	4'8"
Pole Vault	8'6"
Shot Put	29'0"
Discus	90'0"